PERFORMANCE

ELEVATED

VIRAL TRAFFIC SURGE

A major influencer just posted about your product. Traffic is 50× normal and climbing fast. This is the breakthrough moment you have worked toward — but your infrastructure was never load-tested beyond 5× peak capacity.

Horizontal scalability under sudden load requires deliberate architectural choices made long before the traffic spike arrives. Auto-scaling policies must be pre-configured and tested — scaling typically takes 2–5 minutes, which is too late if your servers are already saturated. Caching layers (CDN, application-level cache, database query cache) absorb read traffic without touching compute. Load testing tools such as k6, Locust, or Gatling should be run regularly at realistic peak projections. The key DevOps principle is that infrastructure should be code — defined declaratively, version-controlled, and deployable in minutes. Chaos engineering (deliberately testing how your system behaves at capacity limits) converts theoretical resilience into demonstrated resilience.

Viral moments are binary: you absorb the wave and gain thousands of users, or you crash and they never return.

TEAM DISCUSSION

Can you scale horizontally right now? Is auto-scaling configured, tested, and ready to activate without manual intervention?